PLURALISM

The intellectual roots of pluralism can be found in the concepts, arguments and perspectives of liberal thinking that have directly or indirectly influenced the pluralist image of international politics, especially the liberal institutionalism.

The state-centricism of the realist paradigm, its sole concern with security and military issues and national interest came under scrutiny in the late 1960s and the early 1970s. The changing patterns of international system as well as the emergence of new issues posed a challenge to the 'realist' image of the world order, and the challenge came from the pluralist thinkers. The 'transnationalist' image or the pluralist perspective takes into account the existence of such non-state actors like the MNCs, international organizations such as the Amnesty International, the Catholic Church, OPEC, cartels, and other organizations like terrorist outfits and hijackers. Their main point of argument is that the presence of states as actors cannot be perceived in the absence of **non-state actors**.

They also looked into the existence of **intra-state actors** playing an important role and often influencing foreign policy decisions. For instance, Richard C. Snyder (1954) with his associates had tried to show the foreign policy behaviour of a particular state in terms of both the subjective perceptions of the individuals involved in foreign policy decision-making and the intra-state 'setting' in which they operate, including domestic politics, public opinion, and non-governmental actors.

Some other pluralists such as Alexander George and Ole Holsti[17] have emphasized the role of individuals, their belief patterns and their psycho-pathological traits in the making of foreign policy. Others like Robert Jervis draws attention to the role of cognitive factors in decision-making foreign policy. Scholars such as Irving L. Janis have emphasized the importance of what they call "group think" in the making of foreign policy. Taking the instances of the Bay of Pigs invasion by the USA in 1961, the US unpreparedness regarding the Japanese Pearl Harbour incident in 1941, and the US decision to escalate the Korean and Vietnam wars, as case studies, he argues